

BIZARRE BAZAAR

Asia is one of the world's busiest marketplaces, home to four billion people buying, selling, preparing, producing, and manufacturing everything that can possibly be needed in their daily lives. Carpets and rugs, fresh food and cooked delicacies, televisions and cars, ships and computers—all these and much more are for sale somewhere in this bustling bazaar.

Quick! There's a sale on this way.

Russian Federation

Even without its European part, Siberia—as Asian Russia is known—would still be the biggest country in the world. It is sparsely occupied, since the winters are very harsh and the summers short.

All this rushin'.

Take my picture!

Natural resources

Siberia is rich in timber and has huge oil, gas, and mineral reserves, although many are in remote parts of the country and difficult to access.

Siberian tiger

No more than 500 of these beautiful beasts—the largest tigers in the world—survive in the wilds of far eastern Siberia.

Nice Kitty!

Trans-Siberian railway

The 5,785-mile (9,310-km) Trans-Siberian railway runs from Moscow in the west across Siberia to Vladivostok in the east, with a journey time of eight days to travel from end to end.

Chess

The national game of Russia, chess is regularly played in Siberia during the long winter nights.

Whose turn is it?

I'd better check.

Turkey

Turkey, like Russia, crosses the continents of Asia and Europe, although most of it is in Asia. Its Mediterranean coast attracts many tourists and is an important source of income.

Carpets

Turkish woven kilims, or carpets, are famous throughout the world for their intricate abstract designs.

From rugs to riches.

TURKISH DELIGHT

APRICOTS

KEBABS

SPICED MEATBALLS

FIGS

The Caucasus

The three small, mountainous, and largely agricultural states of the Caucasus lie squashed between the powerful neighboring states of Russia, Iran, and Turkey.

Georgia

Sheltered from cold north winds by the Caucasus mountains, Georgia is a major producer of grapes for wine.

Don't whine.

They're too high!

Smooth as silk.

Textiles

Georgia's significant silk and textile industry forms an important part of its economy.

Caviar

The sturgeon of the Caspian Sea is a highly prized source of caviar—an expensive delicacy.

Fish eggs? Yuck!

More for me!

Azerbaijan

Meaning "land of the flames" after the 8th-century Persians saw burning natural gas escaping from the ground, Azerbaijan exports much oil and natural gas to Europe.

Let's get knitting!

Armenia

The world's oldest Christian nation, Armenia relies primarily on farming, notably sheep rearing, as its main industry.

This would make a good yarn.

The Near East

Bordered by the eastern Mediterranean Sea, with the River Jordan running through it, this ancient region was the birthplace of some of the world's oldest civilizations and religions.

Syria

Cotton is one of the main cash crops grown in Syria, alongside fruit and vegetables.

Lebanon

The national symbol of Lebanon, cedar trees survive in a few protected woods and can live for more than 1,500 years.

Kibbe—a fried ball of lamb, cracked wheat, and onions—is the national dish of Lebanon.